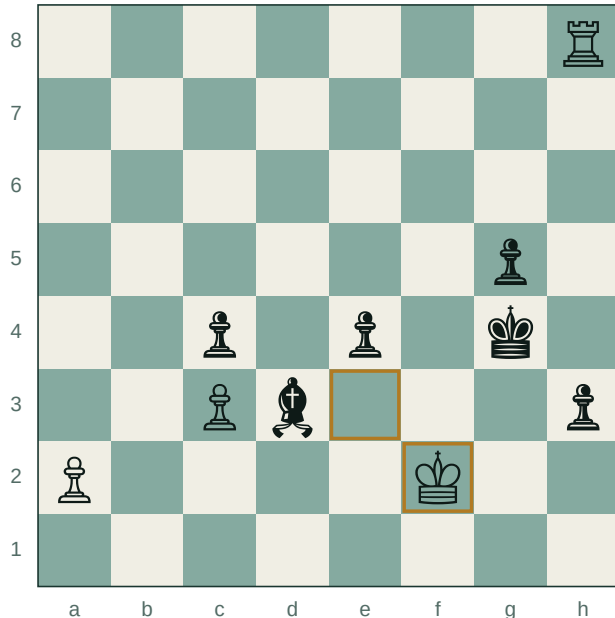


Active defensive resources: Black, move 71

Active defensive resources

Black to move



Previous move: 71.Kf2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

71...e3+ 72. Kxe3 Kg3

71...e3+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **72.Kxe3**.

72...Kg3 The king moves from g4 to g3.

At the end, nominal material is White 7 / Black 6 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by -1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** -1: the balance goes from +0 to -1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on f2. Geometrically undefended: rook on h8. Check for tactical protection.